

Transcendental Meditation

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

30.5

Manual Section Title

Transcendental Meditation

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

11/11/1995

Implementation Date

11/11/1995

Description Information

Benefit Category

Incident to a physician's professional Service

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Transcendental Meditation (TM) is a skill that is claimed to produce a state of rest and relaxation when practiced effectively. Typically, patients are taught TM techniques over the course of several sessions by persons trained in TM. The patient then uses the TM technique on his or her own to induce the relaxed state. Proponents of TM have urged that Medicare cover the training of patients to practice TM when it is medically prescribed as treatment for mild hypertension, as adjunctive therapy in the treatment of essential hypertension, or as the sole or adjunctive treatment of anxiety and other psychological stress-related disorders.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

After review of this issue, CMS has concluded that the evidence concerning the medical efficacy of TM is incomplete at best and does not demonstrate effectiveness and that a professional level of skill is not required for the training of patients to engage in TM.

Although many articles have been written about application of TM for patients with certain forms of hypertension and anxiety, there are no rigorous scientific studies that demonstrate the effectiveness of TM for use as an adjunct medical therapy for such conditions. Accordingly, neither TM nor the training of patients for its use are covered under the Medicare program.

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

79

Revision History

09/1995 - Reflected noncoverage of transcendental meditation and cost of training patients to use it. Effective date 10/11/1995. (TN 79)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Transcendental Meditation	1	11/11/1995 - N/A	You are here